



Preliminary investigation update

Haul truck and light vehicle collision, Bindarra Gold Mine -
Preliminary investigation update

Drafted 30/09/2026

INVESTIGATION WORKFLOW SUITE

Contents

What we know.....	3
What we are looking at.....	4
Containment and next steps.....	5
Distribution	5

Preliminary update - the information in this report is based on the evidence available at the time of writing and may change as the investigation proceeds.

At 02:47 on 11/08/2026, haul truck HT-407, descending the Stage 4 ramp at Bindarra Gold Mine, struck LV-118 leaving the RL 312 dewatering spur. The impact pushed LV-118 18.4 m and onto its left side. The driver, a subcontracted grade control technician, was flown to a metropolitan trauma centre with a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax. LV-118 was destroyed and HT-407 was damaged. The pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes, and the ramp below RL 340 closed for 22 hours. Under examination are how the spur was opened, how intersections are added to the traffic management plan, the collision awareness system's alert suppression, contractor access checks and night shift arrangements. A wet surface and degraded brakes are ruled out. A site-wide direction requires positive radio calls at every Stage 4 intersection.

What we know

Stage 4 is an open pit at the Bindarra Gold Mine. On 31/07/2026 the RL 312 dewatering spur, a 240 m road to a new dewatering bore, was completed under a works order recording that a management of change was not required. On 02/08/2026 the bore was energised, light vehicles began using the spur, and the construction sign at its mouth was removed without replacement. The spur joins the main ramp 34 m beyond a crest. Survey found that a descending haul truck operator first has line of sight to the spur mouth at 41 m.

At about 22:10 local on 04/08/2026, a dewatering technician drove out of the spur in front of a descending haul truck. He estimated it was "maybe sixty metres up" and reversed to let it pass. His hazard report described a rise in the ramp, the windrow (the earth bund along the road edge), and no sign or give-way control at the mouth. The report was closed on 06/08/2026 after the crew were reminded to take care and give way to haul trucks. Its risk rating was reduced from Medium to Low, and it was not referred outside the dewatering department.

On 11/08/2026 (all times local), crews returned from their meal break at 02:22. Haul truck HT-407 was descending empty on its second cycle. A grade control technician from a survey subcontractor, on his third night shift at the mine, was driving light vehicle LV-118 out of the spur. By his account, he slowed to about 25 km/h at the mouth, looked up the ramp, saw nothing and drove out without stopping. Neither driver made a radio call. The spur is not among the nine intersections where the site's traffic management plan requires one.

At 02:47:06 HT-407 was travelling at 37 km/h, 41 m above the intersection. The operator braked, applied the retarder and steered right 1.4 seconds later. The collision awareness system detected LV-118 at 21.4 m but gave no in-cab alert because the intersection lay inside a suppression geofence (an area where alerts are switched off). At 02:47:12 the truck's front left struck LV-118's right side at 24 km/h. The impact pushed LV-118 18.4 m down the ramp and rolled it onto its left side.

At 02:48:01 dispatch stopped Stage 4 traffic and paged the emergency response team. The second responder arrived with the hydraulic rescue tool at 03:07. The driver was extricated through the rear at 03:14, 27 minutes after the collision. The site's review recorded a delay of approximately 9 minutes awaiting the second responder and tool.

The driver was wearing his seatbelt. He had a fractured left clavicle, three fractured left ribs and a small pneumothorax (air in the chest cavity), and was flown to a metropolitan trauma centre at 07:40. The roll-over protection structure was deformed but not breached. LV-118 was destroyed. HT-407 returned to service on 14/08/2026. The truck operator and shift supervisor returned negative drug and alcohol tests. The pit stood down for 9 hours 15 minutes, and the ramp below RL 340 was closed for 22 hours.

What we are looking at

1. **How the RL 312 spur was built and opened.** This covers the works order used to cut the spur, why it recorded a management of change as not required, and what happens to referrals as a result. A management of change normally triggers three referrals: the traffic management plan owner; the survey department, for the in-cab road network; and the contractor's technical services group, for the collision awareness system. Eleven of the fourteen new Stage 4 roads cut since the last plan review used a works order.
2. **How intersections are added to the traffic management plan.** This covers how intersections reach the radio-call list, sight distance and signage requirements, why the list changes only at the annual review, and how intersection hazard reports are assessed and closed. It also covers how the state guideline MSG-14 leaves the review trigger and choice of interaction zones to each site. This is a question of the guideline's structure, not the Inspectorate's performance.
3. **The collision awareness system's suppression geofence.** This covers how the boundary came to be moved on 09/06/2026 without review against the traffic management plan, how suppressed detections are reported, and what operators understood the system to monitor.
4. **Contractor induction and access.** This covers how the site checks completion of the site supplement and the pit driving assessment before issuing a contractor access card. The contractor's site supplement records are still outstanding.
5. **Night shift arrangements across the site.** This covers the emergency response roster on the site's other night shifts and the night roster pattern on all four pits, given the risk each presents on every night shift.
6. **Dust on the ramp.** Whether dust affected the truck operator's view remains open.
A wet road surface and degraded truck brakes were examined and ruled out.

Containment and next steps

Interim action

- Overnight after the collision, a site-wide direction was issued requiring a positive radio call on the pit channel at every Stage 4 intersection, whether or not it is listed in the traffic management plan. It applies to all vehicles operating in Stage 4. [NOT ESTABLISHED: who issued the direction, and whether it remains in force or has been built into BIN-TMP-004.]
- The Mining Manager has been told how intersections are added to the plan's radio-call list, which currently happens only at the annual review. [NOT ESTABLISHED: any action decided as a result.]
- HT-407 returned to service on 14/08/2026 after a repeat brake performance test.

No other interim safety action or containment has been recorded. In particular, no action is recorded on:

- the collision awareness system geofence
- the works order exclusion from management of change
- the checks made before a contractor access card is issued
- the night shift emergency response roster.

Next steps

- Obtain the emergency response roster for the site's other three night shifts from the emergency response coordinator.
- Obtain the survey subcontractor's records for the site supplement, and hold a second conversation with the light vehicle driver.
- Finalise the interview write-ups.
- Record whether dust affected the truck operator's view as still open. The available evidence cannot settle it.
- Have the draft read by someone outside the investigation.
- Give the people and areas it describes the chance to correct matters of fact.
- Confirm an owner and a date for each safety action.

The fuller report is expected [NOT ESTABLISHED: expected date of the final report].

Distribution

Title	Name
General Manager, Bindarra Gold Mine	T. Brandner
Registered Manager (statutory)	S. Kirkhope
Mining Manager and owner of BIN-TMP-004	H. Quaile
Manager Health and Safety, Corella Resources	L. Farquhar
Project Manager, Warrigal Mining Services	D. Mokoena
Superintendent Dewatering, Corella Resources	P. Nyaguse